

Illustration by **GAURAV SARJERAO**



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NITIN GADKARI, 65

UNION MINISTER OF ROAD TRANSPORT AND HIGHWAYS

HIGHWAY STAR

BECAUSE he is the only Union minister who continues to command the image of being his own man, one who is unapologetic about his choices

BECAUSE Gadkari has set a scorching pace for the MoRTH ministry. On May 19, he tweeted that the Ghaziabad-Aligarh Expressway had made history by achieving a remarkable feat—laying bituminous concrete in a lane over a distance of 100 km in an unprecedented 100 hours

BECAUSE he has been a consistent performer during Modi's two terms, and is credited with reviving the highways and ports sectors. Gadkari had set an official target of 12,000 km of new highways in 2022-23; by March 31, 10,331 km were built

WELCOME SIGN **Everyone knows that Gadkari is a gracious host, so it's not uncommon to see his residence brimming with visitors. The guests swear by the savoury Nagpur poha that he often serves**

BECAUSE Gadkari has support among the liberal leaders of the BJP and RSS and despite his exit from the BJP's top decision-making bodies, his opinion still matters on issues concerning development and business outreach

Illustration by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**